

Orexis and Its Three Species in Heidegger's *Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy* (BCAP / GA 18)

Search target: the genus ὄρεξις (*orexis*) and the three species θυμός (*thymos*), βούλησις (*boulēsis*, rational wish), ἐπιθυμία (*epithymia*).

Source: Martin Heidegger, *Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy* (GA 18, 1924 Marburg lectures), trans. Robert D. Metcalf & Mark B. Tanzer (Indiana UP, 2009). PDF: corpus/rhetorical_ontology/Heidegger, Martin - Basic Concepts of Aristotelian Philosophy_(2009)_[Clean Copy].pdf.

Method: full text extracted with pdftotext -layout (text layer intact, Greek preserved); searched per-page on Greek stems (ὄρεξ/ὀρέξ/ὀρεκτ/ὀρέγ, ἐπιθυμ, θυμ, βούλησ/βούλεσθ) plus transliterations. Page numbers below are **BCAP English-edition print pages** (the citable pages); the **GA 18 German pagination** appears in the running heads in brackets and is given where useful; PDF page = print page + 15.

Date: 2026-05-27.

1. Headline findings

1. **The orexis genus and its species are not focal vocabulary in BCAP, and their treatment is concentrated, not diffuse.** They cluster almost entirely in two places: (i) §13 (pp. 72–77), where ὀρεκτικόν appears in the λόγον-ἔχον / ἄλογον division of the soul's being-possibilities; and (ii) §15 (pp. 96–99), where Heidegger expounds *Nicomachean Ethics* Γ.4 (1111b) — Aristotle's demarcation of προαίρεσις (resolution/choice) **against** ἐπιθυμία, θυμός, βούλησις, and δόξα. The aggregated Greek-term appendix the corpus maintains (sorted by frequency, covering λόγος, οὐσία, ψυχή, πάθος, ἔξις, etc.) contains **none** of the four terms — confirming they are secondary in this lecture course, which is built around *pathos*, *hexis*, *logos*, and being-in-the-world.
1. **Heidegger de-psychologizes all four terms; Metcalf & Tanzer leave them untranslated in Greek and Heidegger glosses them phenomenologically as modes of "being-after" (*Aussein auf*).** The conventional renderings the user names — "desire," "appetite" — **do not appear as standing translations**. Instead:
 - ὄρεξις → "being-after," "tendency," "striving" (p. 99);
 - ἐπιθυμία → "being-inclined," "having-an-impulse," "being-impulsive" (p. 97);
 - θυμός → "being-in-excitement," "being-aroused," "having-passion" (p. 97), "blind passion / arousal" (p. 99);
 - βούλησις → "wish," "wishing-for-something" (p. 97).

This is itself the most important finding for the dissertation's *orexis*-family framework: BCAP does **not** supply a worked-out genus/species *psychology* of desire. It supplies an **ontological** reading in which all five phenomena (the four plus δόξα) share the structure of *being-after-something-with-the-character-of-having-it-in-advance*.

1. **The genus/species relation is present but only implicitly.** Heidegger never says "ὄρεξις is the genus of which θυμός, βούλησις, ἐπιθυμία are species" in those words. What he gives is: (a) the *orektikon* (ὀρεκτικόν) as one undivided being-determination of the soul that "shares in λόγος" (p. 72, citing NE A.13, 1102b30); and (b) the three species treated **together** as kindred "being-after" phenomena grouped with προαίρεσις and δόξα (pp. 97–99, citing NE Γ.4). The unifying thread he supplies is structural, not taxonomic: **"This being-after something with the character of the in-advance is found in ἐπιθυμία exactly as it is in θυμός. It is fully explicit in the case of wish [βούλησις]"** (p. 98).

1. The one place ὄρεξις does real definitional work is the *De Anima* I.1 analysis of anger (p. 137): anger defined "as ὄρεξις ἀντιλυπήσεως, being after pay-back" — the dialectician's *eidos*-side definition that the dissertation's emotion section already leans on.
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2. ὄρεξις (*orexis*) — the genus — direct quotations

18 occurrences. The substantive ones:

- p. 51 [GA 18 72–73] — *orexis* as concerned "being-after" that, lacking a *peras*, becomes empty:

"It is impossible that we ... 'take hold of one on account of another. For, in this way, one goes into the unlimited; in this manner, one obtains no πέρας, and so the ὄρεξις, being after something, becomes κενή καὶ ματαία, empty and vain.'" (glossing NE A.1, 1094a19 sqq.; n. 47 gives the Greek: κενὴν καὶ ματαίαν τὴν ὄρεξιν)

- p. 61 [GA 18 87–89] — *orexis* directed at the *telos* / *hou heneka*:

"The οὗ ἕνεκα is that being which stands in a willing, with which I have to do willingly, that which I am after in a certain mode of ὄρεξις, characterized as the end, the ultimate, something that is ultimately τέλος."

- p. 72 [GA 18 104–105] — *orexis* as the mode of being proper to *praxis*; the *orektikon* "shares in *logos*":

"This possibility of hearing, this ἀκουστικόν, is more precisely found together with the mode of being that is fundamentally found in πρᾶξις, with ὄρεξις. Every concern has tendency in itself; it is after something, directed at an ἀγαθόν that is always there as λεγόμενον, as 'something addressed.'" n. 4 (the textual anchor): *Eth. Nic. A* 13, 1102b30 sq.: τὸ δ' ἐπιθυμητικὸν καὶ ὅλως ὀρεκτικὸν μετέχει πως [λόγου] — "the desiring and, in general, the orectic [part] shares somehow in λόγος."

- p. 73 [GA 18 105–107] — *orexis* as "hearing," not "speaking" (its place in the λόγον-ἔχον/ἄλογον scheme):

"the speaking itself is not, as ὄρεξις, genuine speaking; it is only speaking insofar as it listens to the speaking. ... ὄρεξις is not primarily speaking."

- p. 76 [GA 18 110–111] — *orexis* as the "ability-to-hear," i.e. λόγον-ἔχον in the second (ἄλογον) sense:

"This ability-to-hear is a determination of ὄρεξις. Aristotle designates λόγον ἔχον in this second sense as also ἄλογον. The ὄρεξις is not speaking without qualification, but hearing."

- p. 77 [GA 18 111–113] — ὀρεκτικόν listed among the soul's being-determinations:

"These being-determinations (θρεπτικόν, γεννητικόν, αἰσθητικόν, νοητικόν, ὀρεκτικόν) are divided up according to λόγον ἔχον—ἄλογον."

- p. 98 [GA 18 144–145] — προαίρεσις defined as ὄρεξις διανοητική (the bridge between *orexis* and deliberative choice):

"In Book Z, Chapter 2 resolution is characterized as ὄρεξις διανοητική, 'considering being-after,' a being-after that is determined by thorough consideration, by deliberation." (n. 117: NE Z.2, 1139b5)

- p. 99 [GA 18 145–147] — the explicit rendering of ὄρεξις as "a striving," contrasted with δόξα:

"This being-after in δόξα does not have, say, the character of ὄρεξις, of a 'striving.' Δόξα is more of a certain yes; it comes to an end and stops."

- p. 137 [GA 18 203–204] — ὄρεξις in the *De Anima* I.1 definition of anger (the *eidos*-side):

"anger as ὄρεξις ἀντιλυπήσεως, being after pay-back [a certain implacability as a mode of being-toward-others]; the φυσικός defines anger as a determinate boiling up of blood..." n. 262 (Greek): *De an.* A 1, 403a29 sqq.: ὁ μὲν γὰρ ὄρεξιν ἀντιλυπήσεως ἢ τι τοιοῦτον, ὁ δὲ ζέσιν τοῦ περὶ καρδίαν αἵματος καὶ θερμοῦ.

- p. 158 [GA 18 188–189] — ὄρεξις as one being-possibility of the living:

"[the soul has] various being-possibilities ... that it can perceive something (αἰσθῆσις), **that it is after something (ὄρεξις)**, that it can move toward it..."

p. 165 [GA 18 180] — the verb ὀρέγεσθαι (striving for pleasure), glossing NE K.4:

n. 338: *Eth. Nic.* K 4, 1175a10 sqq.: ὀρέγεσθαι δὲ τῆς ἡδονῆς οἰηθεῖται τις ἂν ἅπαντας...

pp. 238, 247 (Handwritten Manuscript / Appendix) — ὄρεξις in schematic lists of the soul's activities:

p. 238: "ψυχῇ: κρίνειν, κινεῖν (ὄρεξις, ποίησις), ἀκούειν..." p. 247: "Δίωξις—φυγή, ὄρεξις, νοεῖν, διανοεῖσθαι, προαίρεσις."

3. ἐπιθυμία (epithymia) — direct quotations

13 occurrences, all but one within §§13–15.

p. 72 [GA 18 104–105] — the *epithymētikōn* as part of the *orektikōn* that shares in *logos*:

n. 4: *Eth. Nic.* A 13, 1102b30 sq.: τὸ δ' ἐπιθυμητικὸν καὶ ὅλως ὀρεκτικὸν μετέχει πως [λόγου].

p. 97 [GA 18 142–144] — the demarcation gloss (Heidegger's rendering of ἐπιθυμία):

"Aristotle demarcates προαίρεσις itself in four directions: (a) in opposition to ἐπιθυμία, 'being-inclined' to something, 'having-an-impulse' for something, 'being-impulsive' about something ..." n. 112: *Eth. Nic.* Γ 4, 1111b10 sqq.: οἱ δὲ λέγοντες αὐτὴν ἐπιθυμίαν ἢ βούλησιν ἢ τινα δόξαν οὐκ εἰκόασιν ὀρθῶς λέγειν — "those who say it [προαίρεσις] is ἐπιθυμία or βούλησις or some δόξα do not seem to speak rightly."

p. 98 [GA 18 144–145] — the shared "being-after" structure, and the *akratēs/enkratēs* contrast:

"This being-after something with the character of the in-advance is found in ἐπιθυμία exactly as it is in θυμός. It is fully explicit in the case of wish." "οὐ γὰρ κοινὸν ἡ προαίρεσις καὶ τῶν ἀλόγων, ἐπιθυμία δὲ καὶ θυμός. 'There is no προαίρεσις ... for living things that do not speak.' ... 'Ἐπιθυμία and θυμός are also found in animals; they are not the same as προαίρεσις since the latter only occurs in living things that speak.'" "καὶ ὁ ἀκρατής ἐπιθυμῶν μὲν πράττει, προαιρούμενος δ' οὐ ... καὶ ἡ μὲν ἐπιθυμία ἡδέος καὶ ἐπιλύπου. 'He who lacks self-control acts ἐπιθυμῶν such that he goes off after the matter. ... 'Ἐπιθυμία and θυμός go after a ἡδύ and a λυπηρόν that disposition supports and tones down.'" (n. 118: *NE Γ.4*, 1111b13 sqq.)

p. 111 [GA 18 ~158] — the desiring-and-hopeful person (Rhetoric, fear/confidence context):

"καὶ τῷ μὲν ἐπιθυμοῦντι καὶ εὐέλπιδι ὄντι, ἐὰν ᾗ τὸ ἐσόμενον ἡδύ, καὶ ἔσσεσθαι καὶ ἀγαθὸν ἔσσεσθαι φαίνεται..."

p. 113 [GA 18 ~161] — ἐπιθυμία heads Aristotle's list of *pathē* (NE B.4):

"λέγω δὲ πάθη μὲν ἐπιθυμίαν ὀργὴν φόβον θάρσος, and so on, 'as a whole, the sort of thing with which ἡδονή and λύπη are co-given.'" (the πάθη / δυνάμεις / ἔξεις triad, NE B.4, 1105b21)

p. 133 [GA 18 148] — ἐπιθυμεῖν among the bodily-involving *pathē* (*De Anima* I.1):

"οἷον ὀργίζεσθαι, θαρρεῖν, ἐπιθυμεῖν, ὅλως αἰσθάνεσθαι" — anger, confidence, desiring, perceiving in general, none "without the body."

4. θυμός (thymos) — direct quotations

Genuine θυμός (the species) occurs at pp. 97, 98, 99, 139 (plus the compound δξύθυμοι "quick-tempered" at p. 173). Caveat: a raw "θυμ" search also catches ἐνθύμημα / ἐνθυμεῖσθαι (*enthymeme*, pp. 85, 87) and ἐπιθυμία — these are **not** the species θυμός and are excluded here.

p. 97 [GA 18 142–144] — the demarcation gloss (Heidegger's rendering of θυμός):

■ "(b) in opposition to θυμός, 'being-in-excitement,' 'being-aroused' about ..., 'having-passion' for ..."

p. 98 [GA 18 144–145] — θυμός shared with animals; goes after the pleasant/painful:

■ "This being-after ... is found in ἐπιθυμία exactly as it is in θυμός." "οὐ γὰρ κοινὸν ἡ προαίρεσις ... ἐπιθυμία δὲ καὶ θυμός." "Ἐπιθυμία and θυμός go after a ἡδύ and a λυπηρόν that disposition supports and tones down." (closing the page) "Προαίρεσις is not a so-called act; it is a genuine possibility of being in the moment. θυμός δ' ἔτι ..."

p. 99 [GA 18 145–147] — θυμός as "arousal / blind passion," least like deliberate choice:

■ "ἥκιστα γὰρ τὰ διὰ θυμὸν κατὰ προαίρεσιν εἶναι δοκεῖ. Aristotle says about θυμός, 'that which is grasped in a state of arousal, in blind passion, has little to do with that which is grasped in clear, lucid resolution.'" (n. 119: NE Γ.4 — i.e. θυμός is furthest from προαίρεσις)

p. 139 [GA 18 154] — θυμός in the *De Anima* I.1 "pathē are inseparable from matter" thesis:

■ n. 270: *De an.* A 1, 403b17 sq.: τὰ πάθη τῆς ψυχῆς οὐ πως χωριστὰ τῆς φυσικῆς ὕλης τῶν ζώων ἢ δὴ τοιαῦθ' ὑπάρχει, θυμός καὶ φόβος — "the affections of the soul are not separable from the natural matter of animals ... such as θυμός and fear."

p. 173 [GA 18 188] — the compound ὀξύθυμοι ("quick-tempered"), *Rhetoric* B.5:

■ n. 373: *Rhet.* B 5, 1382b19 sqq.: ... οὐχ οἱ ὀξύθυμοι καὶ παρρησιαστικοί, ἀλλὰ οἱ πρᾶοι ... (the quick-tempered vs. the gentle/πρᾶοι).

5. βούλησις (boulēsis, rational wish) — direct quotations

Genuine βούλησις (the species "wish") occurs at pp. 97 and 99 (the verb βούλεσθαι at p. 79). *Caveat:* βουλευέσθαι / συμβουλευτικός (deliberation, deliberative rhetoric — 19 hits, pp. 41–112, 175) is the **deliberation** family and is **distinct** from βούλησις-the-wish; do not conflate them.

p. 79 [GA 18 ~94] — the verb βούλεσθαι (to will/choose), in the thief example:

■ "But βούλεσθαι belongs to the genuineness of the way of being of a thief, namely, that a thief chose to steal."

p. 97 [GA 18 142–144] — the demarcation gloss (Heidegger's rendering of βούλησις):

■ "(c) in opposition to βούλησις, 'wish,' 'wishing-for-something'" n. 112: NE Γ.4, 1111b10: οἱ δὲ λέγοντες αὐτὴν ἐπιθυμίαν ἢ βούλησιν ἢ τινα δόξαν...

p. 99 [GA 18 145–147] — the decisive βούλησις/προαίρεσις contrast (wish can aim at the impossible):

■ "προαίρεσις μὲν γὰρ οὐκ ἀδυνάτων ... βούλησις δ' ἐστὶν τῶν ἀδυνάτων, οἷον ἀθανασίας. ... Furthermore, προαίρεσις is not a βούλησις although it looks that way. The difference lies in that to which they are related. Προαίρεσις never goes after something that is impossible. ... Wishing [βούλησις], on the other hand, can be directed at something that is impossible' [e.g. immortality]." (n. 120: NE Γ.4)

6. How Heidegger renders each term (the "desire / appetite" question)

Greek	Conventional translations	Metcalf & Tanzer in BCAP	Heidegger's gloss	Page
ὄρεξις	desire, appetite, striving, longing	left in Greek; "striving" once	"being-after," "tendency," the mode of being in <i>praxis</i> ; "not speaking but hearing"	72, 73, 76, 99
ὀρεκτικόν	the appetitive/orectic part	left in Greek	a being-determination of the soul that "shares in λόγος"	72, 77
ἐπιθυμία	desire, appetite, craving	left in Greek	"being-inclined," "having-an-impulse," "being-impulsive"; goes after the <i>hēdy/lypēron</i>	97, 98

Greek	Conventional translations	Metcalf & Tanzer in BCAP	Heidegger's gloss	Page
θυμός	spirit, anger, passion, spiritedness	left in Greek	"being-in-excitement," "being-aroused," "having-passion"; "arousal, blind passion"	97, 99
βούλησις	wish, (rational) will	"wish," "wishing-for-something"	a "being-after" that can aim at the impossible; not deliberative choice	97, 99

Conclusion on translation: BCAP offers **no** standing English rendering of ὄρεξις/ἐπιθυμία as "desire" or "appetite." Heidegger's whole move is to strip the psychological vocabulary and recover these as *ontological* structures of "being-after-something" (concernful directedness). For the dissertation's convention of keeping the *orexis*-family in Greek and refusing English glosses, **BCAP is a direct precedent and support** — but it does **not** provide a species-psychology (epithymia couplable to bare aisthēsis, thymos needing honor-cognition, boulēsis needing nous-deliberation); that articulation is the dissertation's own, drawn from the *De Anima* / *De Motu* / *Rhetoric*, not from Heidegger.

7. The load-bearing passage (the genus + three species together)

The single passage that gathers genus and all three species is §15, BCAP pp. 97–99 [GA 18 142–147], Heidegger's reading of Aristotle, *Nicomachean Ethics* Γ.4, 1111b — where προαίρεσις is demarcated from ἐπιθυμία, θυμός, βούλησις (and δόξα). Heidegger's organizing claim:

"The five phenomena [ἐπιθυμία, θυμός, βούλησις, δόξα, προαίρεσις] are fully characterized as **being-after something, with the character of having-in-advance**, so that what one is after is there in advance in a particular way. ... This being-after something with the character of the in-advance is found in **ἐπιθυμία** exactly as it is in **θυμός**. It is fully explicit in the case of **wish** [βούλησις]. A being-after something in the direction of the ἀληθές is also found in **δόξα**." (p. 98)

and the species' relation to *proairesis* / *orexis*:

- προαίρεσις = ὄρεξις διανοητική ("considering being-after," NE Z.2 1139b5) — i.e. *orexis* run through deliberation (p. 98);
- ἐπιθυμία and θυμός are sub-rational, shared with animals, "after a ἡδύ and a λυπηρόν" (p. 98);
- θυμός is *furthest* from προαίρεσις ("blind passion," p. 99);
- βούλησις differs from προαίρεσις by its object (can be impossible, e.g. immortality) (p. 99).

8. Page → Aristotle-locus index (for citation)

BCAP p.	GA 18	Term(s)	Aristotle locus	Content
51	72–73	ὄρεξις	NE A.1, 1094a19	<i>orexis</i> without <i>peras</i> is empty/vain
61	87–89	ὄρεξις	Met. Δ.16	<i>orexis</i> toward the <i>telos</i> / <i>hou heneka</i>
72	104–105	ὄρεξις, ἐπιθυμητικόν, ὀρεκτικόν	NE A.13, 1102b30	<i>orektikon</i> "shares in λόγος"; <i>orexis</i> the mode of <i>praxis</i>
73, 76	105–111	ὄρεξις	NE A.13, 1102b–1103a	<i>orexis</i> = "hearing," ἄλογον-as-able-to-hear
77	111–113	ὀρεκτικόν	De an. B.4 / NE Z.2	soul's being-determinations divided λόγον-ἔχον/ἄλογον
96–99	141–147	all four + δόξα + προαίρεσις	NE Γ.4, 1111b (+ Z.2 1139b5; De an. Γ.3)	the demarcation of προαίρεσις from ἐπιθυμία/θυμός/βούλησις/δόξα

BCAP p.	GA 18	Term(s)	Aristotle locus	Content
111	~158	ἐπιθυμία	<i>Rhet.</i> B (fear/confidence)	the desiring-and-hopeful person
113	~161	ἐπιθυμία	<i>NE</i> B.4, 1105b21	πάθη list (ἐπιθυμία, anger, fear, confidence...)
133	148	ἐπιθυμεῖν, θυμός-adjacent	<i>De an.</i> A.1	<i>pathē</i> "not without the body"
137	203–204	ὄρεξις	<i>De an.</i> A.1, 403a30	anger = ὄρεξις ἀντιλυπῆσεως (dialectician's <i>eidos</i>)
139	154	θυμός	<i>De an.</i> A.1, 403b17	θυμός + fear inseparable from matter
158	188–189	ὄρεξις	<i>De an.</i> (soul's powers)	<i>orexis</i> a being-possibility of the living
165	180	ὀρέγεσθαι	<i>NE</i> K.4, 1175a10	striving for pleasure
173	188	ὀξύθυμοι	<i>Rhet.</i> B.5, 1382b19	the quick-tempered vs. the gentle
238, 247	(ms/appendix)	ὄρεξις	—	schematic lists of soul-activities

9. Caveats and what is absent

- **No genus/species taxonomy of desire as such.** Heidegger nowhere lays out "ὄρεξις (genus) → ἐπιθυμία / θυμός / βούλησις (species)" as a doctrine. The three species appear *together* only as the *NE* Γ.4 foils to προαίρεσις (pp. 97–99); ὄρεξις-the-genus and the species are never explicitly coordinated on one page. The dissertation's three-species framework is therefore **its own synthesis**, for which BCAP supplies (a) the de-psychologizing precedent and (b) the *orektikon*-shares-in-*logos* point (p. 72), but not the species-psychology.
- **The *De Anima* III.9–11 / *De Motu* orexis-as-mover material is not treated here.** BCAP is a Rhetoric/*NE*/Metaphysics course; the kinetic role of ὄρεξις as "moved mover" (the diagram's $M_3 \rightarrow A_4$) is *not* developed in it. For that, the dissertation's primary texts remain *DA* III.10 and *MA* 7.
- **ἐπιθυμία's couplability to bare *aisthēsis*** (the dissertation's reason for naming the A_1/A_2 residue "resonant epithymia") is **not** argued in BCAP; the closest support is the "ἐπιθυμία and θυμός ... after a ἡδύ and a λυπηρόν, found also in animals" line (p. 98), which establishes their sub-rational, pleasure/pain-tracking character but not the specific *aisthēsis*-coupling thesis.
- **OCR/typographic notes:** the PDF text layer renders footnote bullets as "â...â•‡" (cosmetic only); Greek diacritics are intact and were verified in context. Page numbers are reliable (PDF = print + 15, per the corpus manifest).
- **Verbatim status:** the Greek and English quotations above are transcribed from the PDF text layer. Before any of these are placed into the interactive diagram or the dissertation, they should be added to `tmp/Dissertation/verbatim_passages.md` and spot-confirmed against the page images per the standing Gross/Heidegger rigor protocol (the four currently-used BCAP pages — 119, 125, 127–128, 135 — are already verified there; pp. 51, 61, 72–77, 96–99, 137 here are **new** and not yet logged).

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